

American Plaice (*Hippoglossoides platessoides*) Snapshot Ecosystem & Socioeconomic Profile

Fall 2026

2026 in Review

Fishing Community Observations

- Steady or increasing availability
- Expanding distributions and changes in migration timing
- Local regulatory complexity affects fishing opportunities

Commercial Fishery

- Number of active vessels declined in 2024, but total landings increased from 2023
- Total revenue decreased slightly along with average prices (\$/lb)
- Average revenue per vessel increased, following an upward trend over the past three years for vessels that remain in the fishery

Recreational Fishery

- Number of targeted trips, catch, and landings all down from 2023
- But number of trips still above the historic average
- Not clear if catch per angler has continued to increase in 2024

Ecosystem

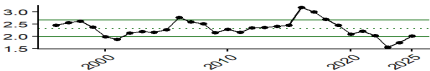
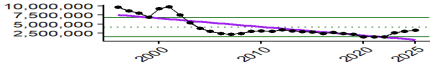
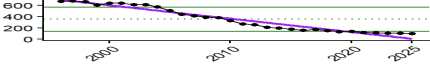
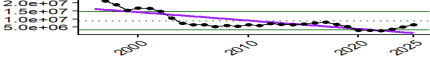
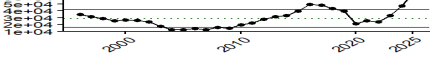
- Cold winter in the north but near average in the south
- Poor or below average fish condition in recent years

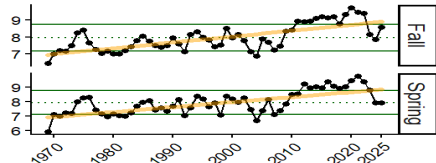
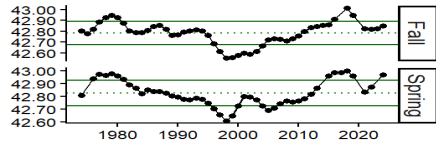
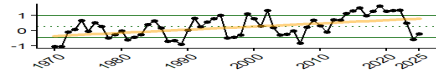
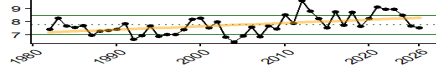
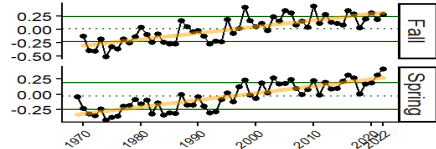
According to the Mid-Atlantic 2026 EAFM risk assessment update, Black Sea Bass scored high and/or moderately high risk in the following elements:

- Moderate-high to high risk to the stock due to:
 - Very high exposure to changing climate
 - Observed and potential changes in distribution; northward shift into the Gulf of Maine
 - Dependence on threatened estuarine habitat
 - Decline in the biomass of benthic invertebrate prey
 - Decline in black sea bass body condition in the Mid Atlantic Bight
- High risk to the recreational fishery due to:
 - Catch exceeding harvest limits in several years
 - High regulatory complexity; frequent changes and varying interstate regulations; regulatory changes in allocations
- Moderate-high risk to the commercial fishery due to:
 - Commercial revenue in wind development areas
 - High discards & discard mortality

Key Points from the Mid-Atlantic Risk Assessment



Indicator Units	Status In 2026	Implications	Time Series
Average price (2025 USD/lb)	Below the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Commercal landings (millions of lbs)	Near the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Number of commercial vessels (# of federally- permitted vessels landing over 1lb of American plaice)	Below the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Commercial revenue (millions, inflation adjusted to 2025 USD)	Near the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Commercial revenue per active American plaice vessel (2025 USD)	Above the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	

Indicator Units	Status In 2026	Implications	Time Series
Bottom temperature (annual prior to Fall and Spring surveys, °C)	Near the long term mean (fall and spring)	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Center of Gravity (Latitude)	Near the long term mean (fall), above the long term mean (spring)	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Gulf Stream Index (annual mean prior to Fall survey)	Near the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Sea Surface Temperature (Mar-June)	Near the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
AMO (6 months prior to Fall and Spring survey)	Above the long term mean (fall and spring)	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	

Please contact nefsc.esp.leads@noaa.gov with any questions or comments.